

Ayushi Chaudhary

Senior UX Researcher | Complex Systems

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🔗 <https://ayushicn.github.io/portfolio/>

Profile

Senior UX Researcher experienced in leading strategic, ambiguity-driven research across complex, global SaaS products

I specialize in shaping product direction through foundational, generative, and evaluative research; translating nuanced user insights into clear, high-impact product and roadmap decisions.

I bring extensive experience working across **Europe, the US, and APAC**, partnering closely with **Product, Design, Engineering, and Executive stakeholders** to influence high-stakes decisions in **regulated, enterprise, and multi-persona environments**. At Whatfix, I've owned end-to-end research across **0-to-1 initiatives**, platform expansion, and AI-driven innovation, while also **scaling research maturity through mentorship, scalable frameworks, and cross-functional enablement**.

My training in Design for Interaction at **Delft University of Technology** emphasized systems thinking, human-centered design, and rigorous research methodologies, an approach that continues to shape how I frame and solve complex product and business problems.

Professional Experience

Senior User Researcher, *Whatfix*

05/2022 – 05/2025

Research ownership in complex, ambiguous problem spaces & driving product decisions

Bangalore, India

- Owned end-to-end research for multiple 0-to-1 and expansion initiatives, partnering with Product and Design leadership to **define problem spaces, prioritize opportunities, and influence roadmap decisions**.
- Led foundational and generative research to establish Product-Market Fit for Whatfix Mirror (simulation software), directly contributing to a **500% revenue increase**.
- Led concept validation and usability research for the Whatfix Dashboard, driving UX improvements that increased client adoption from **8 to 700 users**, with the entire research-to-decision cycle completed within one month.
- Spearheaded exploratory research on **AI integration and automation**, defining clear user needs, MVP scope, and product vision; aligning stakeholders on execution priorities and **enabling faster MVP development and onboarding of the first design partners**.
- Delivered strategic data-backed research insights that influenced executive decision-making, including halting non-viable product initiatives, preventing long-term resource drain and helping leadership sharpen company-wide focus on higher-impact expansion initiatives.
- Owned the research for product expansion opportunities in the productivity domain, directly contributing to the **winning idea at the Whatfix Global Hackathon '23**.

Cross-Functional collaboration & impact

- Partnered deeply with PMs, Designers, Engineers, CSMs, and senior leadership to embed research across the full product lifecycle; reducing misalignment and rework, and enabling faster, research-led roadmap decisions.

- Translated complex research findings into clear, actionable narratives for cross-functional teams and executives, accelerating alignment and decision-making across multiple geographies.

Scaling research practice & culture

- Led parts of "Every Person is a Researcher" initiative, **increasing research activity by 160% and driving a 55% rise in teams actively using research insights.**
- Mentored and enabled **40+ colleagues through 1:1 coaching** and workshops, improving research quality and increasing confident, independent research execution across teams.
- Designed, implemented and led Discovery Research framework and Quality Assurance program, **improving research rigor across 60% of the design team.**
- Established the UX Research foundation as the first researcher in Whatfix India, defining best practices and frameworks adopted company-wide; enabling the research function to scale, democratising research practices, and significantly improving the quality and impact of research- supported product initiatives.

Design Research Graduate, *The Art of Living Foundation*

- Owned and executed end-to-end design research, applying qualitative and evaluative methods to understand user needs and inform solution development.
- Designed and implemented a user-centered tool to increase Art of Living SKY course enrolment among Dutch young adults.

03/2021 – 11/2021
Delft, The Netherlands

Service Research & Design Intern, *KLM Royal Dutch Airlines*

- Designed a comprehensive 'board meeting process' to support decision making within a complex organizational environment especially involving various executives.
- Drove work across all project phases; from research and synthesis to concept development and validation; supporting strategic alignment in a highly regulated aviation context.

09/2019 – 01/2020
Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Education

MSc., Design For Interaction (CGPA: 8.0),
Delft University of Technology, The Netherlands

09/2018 – 11/2021
Delft, The Netherlands

B.Tech., Civil Engineering (CGPA: 8.4),
Harcourt Butler Technological University, Kanpur

08/2012 – 06/2016
Kanpur, India

Skills

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| • Research Strategy & Roadmapping | • Foundational, Generative & Evaluative Research |
| • Mixed-Methods Research | • Product Discovery |
| • Recruitment & Participant Sampling | • Persona Creation |
| • Journey Maps | • Contextual Inquiry |
| • Iterative Prototype Testing | • Stakeholder Management |
| • Usability & Concept Validation | • Multi-Persona & Buyer User Research |
| • Insight Synthesis & Storytelling | • Executive & Cross- Functional Communication |
| • Workshop Facilitation | • Co-Creation & Enablement |
| • Creative Facilitation | |

Tools

Research & Synthesis

Condens.io, Maze, Confluence,
Userinterviews, SurveyMonkey,
Zoom

Collaboration & Facilitation

Mural/Miro, Figma, Canva

**AI-Assisted Research & Data
Analysis**

Userology, Gemini, ChatGPT,
Google AI Studio